

Adding Captions to Tables

Generated Aug 4, 2026 9:53 PM

What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can add a descriptive title to an HTML table using the `<caption>` element.

Before We Start

Look at a table in a book, report, or class record.

How does the title help you understand what the table is about?

Let's Understand

A table caption is a short title or description that explains the purpose of a table.

The `<caption>` element adds a caption to an HTML table.

It must be placed inside the `<table>` element, usually immediately after the opening `<table>` tag.

```
<table>
  <caption>Student Information</caption>
  <tr>
    <th>Name</th>
    <th>Grade Level</th>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>Angela</td>
    <td>Grade 9</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

In this example:

- `<caption>` gives the table the title Student Information.
- `<tr>` creates a table row.
- `<th>` creates a table heading cell.
- `<td>` creates a table data cell.

Web browsers usually display the caption above the table.

A clear caption helps readers quickly understand the information presented in the table.

The caption should be short, specific, and related to the table data.

Let's Practice

Study the following HTML table:

```
<table>
  <caption>Weekly Class Schedule</caption>
  <tr>
    <th>Day</th>
    <th>Subject</th>
    <th>Time</th>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>Monday</td>
    <td>Mathematics</td>
    <td>8:00 AM</td>
  </tr>
  <tr>
    <td>Tuesday</td>
    <td>Science</td>
    <td>9:00 AM</td>
  </tr>
</table>
```

Answer the following questions:

1. What is the caption of the table?
2. Which element creates the table caption?
3. Where is the `<caption>` element placed?
4. How many table headings are present?
5. How many rows and columns does the table contain?

Let's Look at Examples

School Canteen Menu with a Caption

This example uses a caption to describe the information presented in a school canteen menu.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>School Canteen Menu</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Our School Canteen</h1>

  <table>
    <caption>Available Food and Prices</caption>
    <tr>
      <th>Food</th>
      <th>Price</th>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>Sandwich</td>
      <td>₹35</td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>Spaghetti</td>
      <td>₹50</td>
    </tr>
    <tr>
      <td>Fruit Salad</td>
      <td>₹40</td>
    </tr>
  </table>
</body>
</html>
```

The caption Available Food and Prices explains what information the table contains.

The table has four rows and two columns. The first row contains the headings Food and Price.

The remaining rows contain the available food and their corresponding prices.

Common mistake

Students may place the <caption> element outside the <table> element. The caption must be placed inside the table, usually immediately after the opening <table> tag.

Resources / References

- [HTML table captions reference](#)
- [HTML table headings reference](#)
- [HTML table rows and data cells reference](#)